



Anderson Supporter

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African emigration ca. 25,000 years ago, but why do Powledge and Rose deny the ample evidence for this more recent change?

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Mark Rose responds: Sykes and his colleagues note the spread of archaeological cultures (as identified from pottery types and farming and animal husbandry) at the same time as their genetic data suggests the entry of some Middle Eastern people into Europe. One would hope to be able to identify a similar correspondence between genetic and archaeological evidence for the claimed 22,000 B.P. date for the African/non-African DNA split. This date seems at odds, however, with the appearance of modern humans in the Middle East as early as 90,000 to 120,000 years ago at Skhul and Qafzeh caves, the replacement of Neanderthals by modern humans in western Europe during the period from 40,000 to 30,000 years ago, and innovations such as new tool types and cave painting by 30,000. The fossil and artifactual record suggests "Europeans" were in place before the 22,000 B.P. date and modern humans had dispersed from Africa

long before that. Sykes' data suggest that modern Europeans are largely descended from these people.

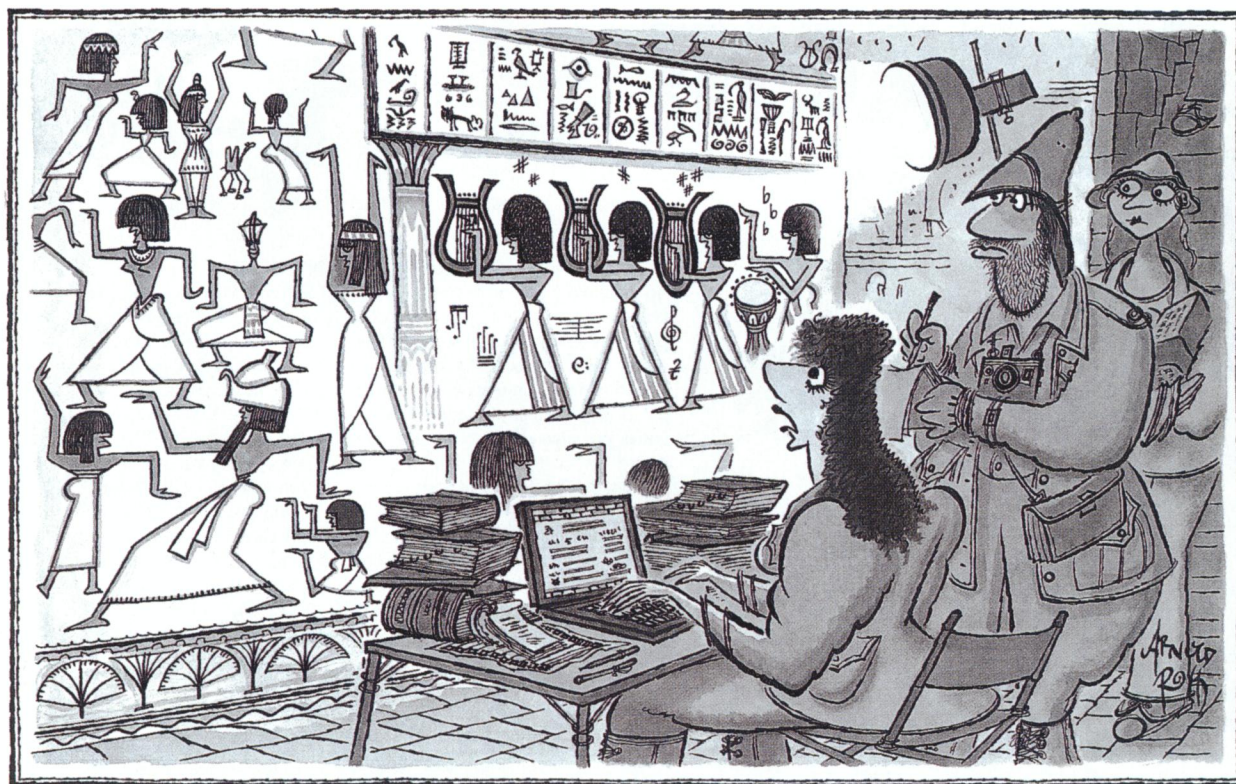
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"Fingerprinting the Dead" (November/December 1996) contained one statement I would like to clarify: "[Anna] Anderson's claim to be Anastasia was disproved when a sample of her mtDNA failed to match that of Prince Philip." While the blood samples from Prince Philip and Countess Xenia Sfiru, as well as the bone sample from the remains of Grand Duke Georgi, cannot be disputed, the tissue sample purportedly belonging to Anna Anderson was retrieved from a paraffin block kept in the Martha Jefferson Hospital in Charlottesville, Virginia. It was not retrieved from the remains of Anderson, who was cremated upon her death in 1984. In her favor, Otto Reche, president of the Society of German Anthropologists, after a thorough study, declared his conviction that she was Anastasia. Moritz Furt-

mayr, a forensic anthropologist who pioneered the identification procedure based on the cardinal points of the face, came to the same conclusion. Mina Becker, the graphologist who authenticated Anne Frank's diary, declared her absolute conviction the Anna Anderson and Anastasia were the same person. Much other evidence of a scientific nature and otherwise could be cited. It is a violation of scientific procedure to disregard all previous evidence and accept a single new finding without further evaluation. The case of Grand Duchess Anastasia is far from being resolved.

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It does say, "Rock 'n Roll will live forever."